LESSON 3

History of Global Politics: Creating an International Order

TODAY'S TOPICS

WHAT WE'LL DISCUSS

Introduction
Attributes
History/Origin
Important Events
Importance/Significance
Cons and Pros

The world is composed of many countries or states, all of them having different forms of governments. As the world moves on with the tick of time, interactions and diplomacy all around the world is expected to persist in order to build an international system. Scholars study and explore the deepening relations between states, this is called internationalization.

Note: Internationalization does not equal globalization; the former is just a major part of the latter.

INTRODUCTION

The Attributes of Today's Global System

THE FOUR KEY ATTRIBUTES OF TODAY'S POLITICS:

- ✓ -Independent and self-governing countries or states.
- ✓ -These countries interact with each other through diplomacy
- ✓ Presence of international organizations such as United Nations (UN)
- ✓ -International organizations also take lives of their own

HISTORY/ORIGIN OF TODAY'S GLOBAL SYSTEM

A good start to trace back the origin of today's global system is by defining the two non-interchangeable terms, nation-state.

In layman's terms, state refers to a country and its government, i.e., the government of the Philippines.
A state has four attributes:
-It exercises authority over a specific population, called its citizens.
-It governs a specific territory.
-It has a structure of government that
crafts various rules that people follow.
-It has sovereignty
over its territory.

HISTORY/ORIGIN OF TODAY'S GLOBAL SYSTEM

On the other hand, the nation, according to Benedict Anderson, is an "imagined community." It is limited because it does not go beyond a given "official boundary," and because rights and responsibilities are mainly the privilege and concern of the citizens of the nation.

Calling it "imagined" does not mean that the nation is made-up. Rather, the nation allows one to feel a connection with a community of people even if he/she will never meet all of them in his/her lifetime.

HISTORY/ORIGIN OF TODAY'S GLOBAL SYSTEM

Having differentiated the two, it is important to know that most nations strive to become states. Nation-builders can only feel a sense of fulfilment when their national ideal assumes an organizational form whose authority and power are recognized and accepted by "the people."

In the modern and contemporary era, it has been the nationalist movements that have allowed for the creation of nation-states. States become independent and sovereign because of nationalist sentiment that clamor for this independence.

Nation and state are closely related because it is nationalism that facilitates state formation. In pursuit of this, diplomacy and interactions between countries/states have found its way to build today's global system.

So to speak, sovereignty is, thus, one of the fundamental principles of modern state politics. Understanding how this became the case goes back as far as 400 years ago.

IMPORTANT EVENTS

The Westphalian system provided stability for the nations of Europe, until it faced its first major challenge by **Napoleon Bonaparte** who believed in spreading the principles of the French Revolution– liberty, equality, and fraternity.

Anglo and Prussian armies defeated Napoleon in the **Battle of Waterloo** in 1815 that completely stopped the spread of Napoleonic code..

IMPORTANT EVENTS

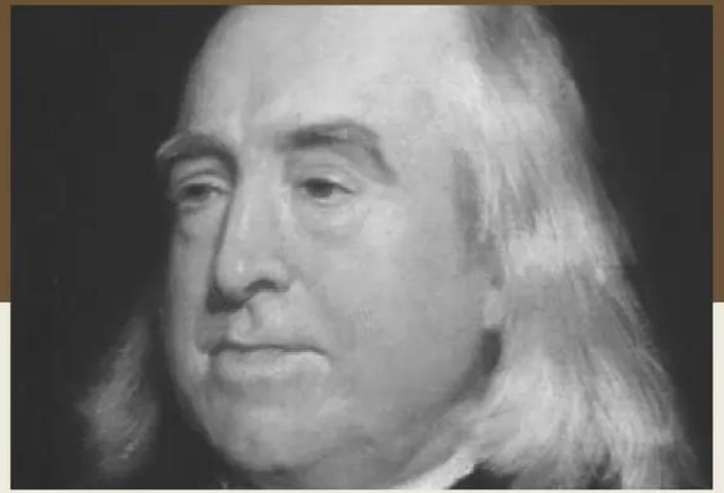
The **Concert of Europe** was formed with the alliance of United Kingdom, Austria, Russia, and Prussia, also known as “great powers,” that sought to restore the world monarchical, hereditary, and religious privileges of the time before the French Revolution and the Napoleonic Wars.
The Concert of Europe collapsed at the dawn of World War I, 1914, but it still holds significant influence over the world politics.

Others imagine a system of heightened interaction between various sovereign states, particularly the desire for greater cooperation and unity among states and people. This desire came to beknown as **internationalism**..

Important Events

Immanuel Kant

was a German Philosopher and was the first major thinker of liberal internationalism. Kant likened states in a global system people living in a given territory. He argued that a state must have a form of government.



Jeremy Bentham

Writingin the late 18th Century af ter Kant, British philosopher Jeremy Bentham (who coined the word “international” in 1780), advocated the creation of “international law” that would govern the inter-state relations.

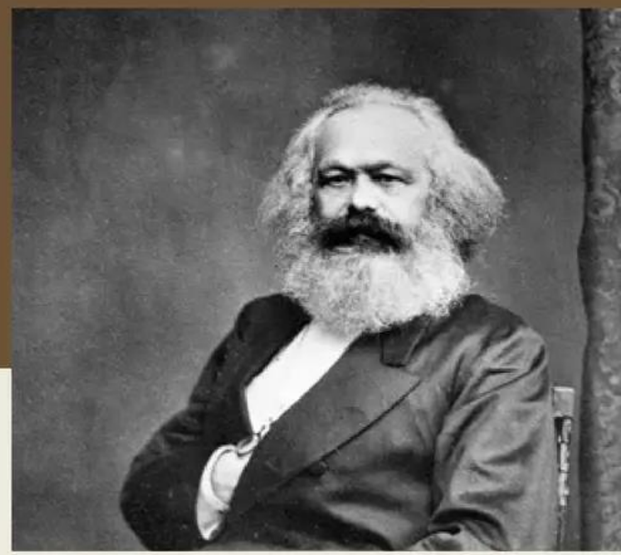
Giuseppe Mazzini

The first thinker to reconcile nationalism with liberal internationalism.He believed in a Republican government and proposed a system of free nations.

Important Events

Woodrow Wilson

became one of the 20th century's most prominent internationalist. He believed in the principle of self-determination—the belief that the world's nations had a right to a free, and a sovereign government.



Karl Marx

was also an internationalist, but who differed from the former because he did not believe in nationalism. He believed that an true form of internationalism should deliberately reject nationalism.

IMPORTANT EVENTS

§The League of Nations that Woodrow Wilson pushed came into being in 1919, and upon its failure, gave birth to international organizations that are still around until today, the most popular of which are the **World Health Organization** (WHO) and the **International Labour Organization** (ILO).

§After Marx died in 1883, his followers established **The Socialist International** (SI) was a union of European socialist. SI's achievements included the declaration of May 1 as Labor Day and the creation of an International Women's Day.

§The SI collapsed during World War I and more radical version emerged: **The Communist International** (Comintern)established by Vladimir Lenin, the leader of Bolshevik Party. The Comintern served as central body for directing Communist party all over the world.

IMPORTANT EVENTS

§Lenin's successor, Joseph Stalin, dissolved the Comintern in 1943 and later on, re-established it as the **Communist Information Bureau** (Cominform). The Cominform , like the Comintern before, it helped direct the various communist parties that had taken power in Eastern Europe.

§For the postwar period, liberal internationalism would once again be ascendant. And **United Nations** rose as the center of global governance.

Importance/ Significance of Creating International Order

- It helps set the international agenda, mediating political bargaining, providing a place for political initiatives.

- It acts as catalysts for coalition-formation. Cooperation and coordination among member nations will be facilitated.

- It works to shape the international settlement in more structured, collaborative and rule-bound ways.

-It enables collective problem-solving and it also avert protectionist impulses and stabilize world economy.

At first glance, there seems to be no downsides of this goal, however creating international order is actually harder than it seems. The major issue that states/countries must overcome is the disagreement between each other. Having different cultures may mean they would have different values that they would have difficult time to compromise with each other. If pride takes on, opposition may even be born and result to more chaos which is the complete opposite of their goal.

On the other hand, keeping in touch with different states/countries may pave the way to harmony. They may be able to accept and respect their differences and solve the cracks in their relationships. Diplomacy may be the key aspect to achieve international order. Assuming that everything goes well, countries will greatly benefit from this and eventually the world will be engulfed in peace..

CONS AND PROS OF CREATING INTERNATIONAL ORDER

TREATIES/CONVENTIONS FORMULATED

TREATY OF WESTPHALIA

-set of agreements signed in 1648 to end the Thirty Years' War between major continental of Europe.

- recognized the full territorial sovereignty of the member states of the empire. They were empowered to contract treaties with one another and with foreign powers, provided that the emperor and the empire suffered no prejudice.

CONCERT OF EUROPE

-alliance of "**great powers**"-The United Kingdom, Austria, Russia, Prussia

- sought to restore the world **monarchical, hereditary and religious priveldges** of the time before French Revolution and Napoleonic Wars.

TREATIES/CONVENTIONS FORMULATED

METTERNICH SYSTEM

-series of meetings among the more powerful European nations between the Napoleonic War and World War I

-its objective was to **resolve disputes between European nations.**

-under the architecture of Klemens von Metternick, a series of Congress meetings were held among the greater European powers in an attempt to maintain European peace.Amid increasing disagreements between the major powers the Congress system collapsed just prior to the start of World War **I.**

SOCIALIST INTERNATIONAL

-union of Europea socialist and labor parties established in Paris in **1889.**

-It currently brings together **135 political parties** and organisations from all continents.

STATUTE CREATED

INTERNATIONAL LAW

-is central to promoting economic and social development, as well as to advancing international peace and security.

-consists of rules and principles governing the relations and dealings of nations with each other.

NAPOLEONIC CODE

-It was drafted by a commission of four eminent jurists and entered into force on 21 March 1804.

-implemented by French that forbade birth privileges, encouraged freedom or religion and promoted Meritocracy ingovernment services.

COMMUNIST INTERNATIONAL

-served as the central body for directing Communist parties all over the world.

-known also as the Third International (1919–1943), was an international organization that advocated world communism.